



3 days in Jaipur

Rajasthan · Mid-range 🏰 · starting from Chennai

₹4,800/day · fits your budget 🎉

Estimated ₹14,400 for the full trip against your ₹15,000 — ₹600 spare for shopping and second desserts.

Day 1 Amber Fort & the old city



MORNING

Be at Amber Fort by 8am — walk up the ramp like the locals instead of the elephant ride (the elephants have a rough life anyway). On the way out, slip through the back lane to Panna Meena ka Kund stepwell.



AFTERNOON

Photo stop at Jal Mahal on the drive back, then City Palace (₹300; the ₹1,500 royal-quarters ticket is skippable). Cool off in the museum galleries during peak heat.



EVENING

Hawa Mahal glows around 5pm — see it from the Wind View Cafe rooftop opposite (buy a lassi, the view is the ticket). Then wander Johari Bazaar as the lights come on.



BREAKFAST

Pyaz kachori + jalebi at Rawat Misthan Bhandar (₹60 will change your life)



LUNCH

Rajasthani thali at LMB (Laxmi Misthan Bhandar) in Johari Bazaar — ₹400, arrive hungry



DINNER

Masala Chowk food court at Ramniwas Bagh — 20 famous street vendors in one courtyard, ₹150–250

Day 2 Astronomy, art & a sunset fort



MORNING

Jantar Mantar right at opening (the giant sundial is accurate to 2 seconds — get the audio guide, it makes the stone instruments come alive), then Albert Hall's oddball museum.



AFTERNOON

Auto out to Sanganer for a block-printing and blue pottery workshop (₹300–500), or the Anokhi Museum of Hand Printing if you'd rather watch than do.



EVENING

Nahargarh Fort for sunset — chai at Padao Cafe on the ramparts. Dinner back in town, or Chokhi Dhani village resort if you want the full folk-dance-and-thali theatre (₹1,100+, honestly fun with kids).



BREAKFAST

Kanji vada + masala chai at Sahu Chai (Chaura Rasta) with the newspaper readers



LUNCH

Dal baati churma at Santosh Bhojnalaya — workers' canteen prices, wedding-level ghee



DINNER

Laal maas at Handi on MI Road (₹500) — order roti, not naan, and thank me later

Day 3

Temples, bazaars & a single-screen classic



MORNING

Galta Ji (monkey temple) before it heats up — climb past the tanks to the Surya Mandir for the panorama. Keep snacks zipped away; the monkeys are professionals.



AFTERNOON

Bazaar crawl: mojari shoes in Bapu Bazaar, quilts in Chandpol, lac bangles in Maniharon ka Rasta. Bargain from half the quoted price with a smile.



EVENING

Catch any film at Raj Mandir — India's most gloriously over-the-top single-screen cinema (₹200–400, book the balcony). Finish with the famous Lassiwala on MI Road (the original — No. 312).



BREAKFAST

Doodh-jalebi at Gopalji ka Rasta — dunk, don't sip



LUNCH

Thali at Sharma Dhaba on Sikar Road if you're bazaar-side, or Masala Chowk again (no shame)



DINNER

Rooftop at Tattoo Cafe opposite Hawa Mahal — average food, unbeatable night view; eat light, you had lassi



Budget breakdown (per person)

	/day	× 3 days
Stay	₹2,500	₹7,500
Food	₹1,000	₹3,000
Local transport	₹700	₹2,100
Activities & entries	₹600	₹1,800
Total	₹4,800	₹14,400

🚶 Getting there: Trains from Delhi take 4–5h (₹300–800 in AC chair car); from Mumbai it's an overnighter (₹900–1,800). Flights from the metros run ₹3,000–6,000 if booked 3+ weeks out.



Hidden gems locals love

- ✦ **Panna Meena ka Kund** — the symmetrical stepwell 5 min walk from Amber Fort's back gate — most tour groups never find it.
- ✦ **Galta Ji at golden hour** — the 'monkey temple' in a hill pass; skip the touts and climb to the sun temple for the best free city view.
- ✦ **Blue pottery workshop in Sanganer** — watch (and try) the craft instead of buying it marked-up in Bapu Bazaar.
- ✦ **Padao Cafe on Nahargarh's ramparts** — a ₹100 chai with the whole pink city glowing below at sunset.

- ✦ **Old city heritage walk at 7am** — the havelis of Chandpol before shutters open — chai + doodh-jalebi with the shopkeepers.

Getting around

- ✦ **Auto-rickshaw** · ₹50–150 per hop — agree the fare before you sit — meters are decorative here
- ✦ **Uber / Ola** · ₹80–200 across town — cheap and drama-free; use for Amber (30 min ride)
- ✦ **E-rickshaw in the old city** · ₹30–50 — the sane way between bazaars
- ✦ **Full-day cab** · ₹2,300–2,800 — worth it on your Amber + Nahargarh day if you're 3–4 people

Best time to visit

October to March — daytime is a pleasant 20–28°C and the evenings at the forts are gorgeous. The Jaipur Literature Festival (late Jan) is brilliant but book stays early.

What to avoid

- ⚠ May–June: it genuinely hits 45°C, the forts are punishing by 11am.
- ⚠ "Gem factory" and "government emporium" detours your auto driver suggests — classic commission traps. A firm 'nahi chahiye' works.
- ⚠ Amber Fort after 10:30am — the tour-bus crowds arrive; go at opening (8am).

 **Change plan**

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Made with  chai and window seats — prices are honest estimates; haggle like a local.